

Examples

1. **Draw two cards (without replacement) from a well-shuffled deck. Calculate the following.**

- (a) **Pr(2nd card is an ace)**

$$\Pr(\text{2nd card is an ace}) = \Pr(\text{1st card is an ace}) = 4/52 = 1/13 \approx 7.7\%.$$

- (b) **Pr(2nd card is an ace | 1st card is an ace)**

$$\Pr(\text{2nd card is an ace} \mid \text{1st card is an ace}) = 3/51 \approx 5.9\%.$$

- (c) **Pr(2nd card is an ace | 1st card is not an ace)**

$$\Pr(\text{2nd card is an ace} \mid \text{1st card is not an ace}) = 4/51 \approx 7.8\%.$$

- (d) **Pr(both cards are aces)**

$$\begin{aligned} \Pr(\text{both cards are aces}) &= \Pr(\text{1st card is ace}) \times \Pr(\text{2nd card is ace} \mid \text{1st card is ace}) \\ &= (4/52) \times (3/51) \approx 4.5/1000. \end{aligned}$$

- (e) **Pr(2nd card is an ace | 1st card is a heart)**

$$\Pr(\text{2nd card is an ace} \mid \text{1st card is a heart}) = 4/52 = 1/13 \approx 7.7\%$$

(These are independent.)

To spell it out completely:

$$\begin{aligned} &\Pr(\text{2nd card is an ace} \mid \text{1st card is a heart}) \\ &= \Pr(\text{1st card is a heart and 2nd card is an ace}) / \Pr(\text{1st card is a heart}) \\ &= [\Pr(\text{1st card is ace of hearts and 2nd card is an ace}) \\ &\quad + \Pr(\text{1st card is heart but not ace and 2nd card is an ace})] \\ &\quad / \Pr(\text{1st card is a heart}) \\ &= [(1/52) \times (3/51) + (12/52) \times (4/51)] / (1/4) \\ &= 1/13 \approx 7.7\%. \end{aligned}$$

- (f) **Pr(get a pair)** (i.e., the two cards have the same face).

$$\begin{aligned} \Pr(\text{get a pair}) &= \Pr(\text{AA or 22 or 33 or 44 or } \dots \text{ or QQ or KK}) \\ &= \Pr(\text{AA}) + \Pr(\text{22}) + \Pr(\text{33}) + \dots \Pr(\text{KK}) \\ &= 13 [(4/52) \times (3/51)] \\ &= 3/51 \approx 5.9\%. \end{aligned}$$

Alternatively, $\Pr(\text{get a pair}) = \Pr(\text{2nd card has same face as first card}) = 3/51 \approx 5.9\%$.

2. The seeds in Mendel's pea plants were either smooth or wrinkled, the result of a single gene with the smooth allele (A) dominant to the wrinkled allele (a). Similarly, the seeds were either yellow or green, with yellow (B) dominant to green (b).

The F_1 hybrid seeds produced from crossing two pure-breeding lines (one with smooth, yellow seeds; the other with wrinkled, green seeds) are all smooth and yellow.

Consider growing up an F_1 seed, selfing it, and then taking a random F_2 seed.

- (a) **Pr(F_2 seed is smooth)**

$$\Pr(F_2 \text{ seed is smooth}) = 1 - \Pr(F_2 \text{ seed is wrinkled}) = 1 - (1/2) \times (1/2) = 3/4 = 75\%.$$

- (b) **Pr(F_2 seed is green)**

$$\Pr(F_2 \text{ seed is green}) = 1/4 = 25\%.$$

- (c) **Pr(F_2 seed is smooth and green)**

$$\Pr(F_2 \text{ seed is smooth and green}) = (3/4) \times (1/4) = 3/16 \approx 19\%.$$

[Since the two genes are unlinked, “the F_2 seed is smooth” and “the F_2 seed is green” are independent.]

- (d) **Pr(F_2 seed has genotype AA)**

$$\Pr(F_2 \text{ seed has genotype } AA) = 1/4 = 25\%.$$

- (e) **Pr(F_2 seed has genotype AA | it is smooth)**

$$\begin{aligned} \Pr(F_2 \text{ seed has genotype } AA \mid \text{it is smooth}) \\ &= \Pr(F_2 \text{ seed has genotype } AA \text{ and is smooth}) / \Pr(F_2 \text{ seed is smooth}) \\ &= (1/4) / (3/4) = 1/3 = 33\%. \end{aligned}$$

3. Consider an urn with 3 red balls and 2 blue balls.

- (a) **Draw 2 balls *with replacement*.**

- i. **Pr(both balls are red)**

$$\Pr(\text{both balls are red}) = (3/5) \times (3/5) = 9/25 = 36\%.$$

- ii. **Pr(the two balls are the same color)**

$$\begin{aligned} \Pr(\text{the balls are the same color}) &= \Pr(\text{both balls are red}) + \Pr(\text{both balls are blue}) \\ &= (3/5) \times (3/5) + (2/5) \times (2/5) = 9/25 + 4/25 \\ &= 13/25 = 52\% \end{aligned}$$

- (b) **Repeat the above when the draws are *without replacement*.**

- i. **Pr(both balls are red)**

$$\Pr(\text{both balls are red}) = (3/5) \times (2/4) = 6/20 = 30\%.$$

- ii. **Pr(the two balls are the same color)**

$$\begin{aligned} \Pr(\text{the balls are the same color}) &= \Pr(\text{both balls are red}) + \Pr(\text{both balls are blue}) \\ &= (3/5) \times (2/4) + (2/5) \times (1/4) = 6/20 + 2/20 \\ &= 8/20 = 40\% \end{aligned}$$

4. **Roll two fair, six-sided dice (or roll one fair, six-sided dice twice).**

(a) **Pr(both dice are 1)**

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Pr(both are 1)} &= \text{Pr(1st die is 1 and 2nd die is 1)} \\ &= \text{Pr(1st die is 1)} \times \text{Pr(2nd die is 1)} \quad (\text{They are independent.}) \\ &= (1/6) \times (1/6) = 1/36 \approx 2.8\%.\end{aligned}$$

(b) **Pr(at least one die is a 1)**

We consider three different approaches to calculating this probability.

- i. There are 36 different possible outcomes and they are equally likely. 11 of these outcomes satisfy the condition, “at least one die is a 1.” Thus the probability is $11/36 \approx 31\%$.
- ii. Let $A = \{ \text{1st die is a 1} \}$ and $B = \{ \text{2nd die is a 1} \}$.

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Pr}(A \text{ or } B) &= \text{Pr}(A) + \text{Pr}(B) - \text{Pr}(A \text{ and } B) \\ &= 1/6 + 1/6 - 1/36 \\ &= 11/36 \approx 31\%.\end{aligned}$$

- iii. $\text{Pr}(\text{at least one 1}) = 1 - \text{Pr}(\text{no 1's})$
 $= 1 - (5/6) \times (5/6) = 1 - 25/36$
 $= 11/36 \approx 31\%.$

5. (A sort of famous 17th century French gambling problem.)

Which of the following is more likely “at least one 1 in 4 rolls of a six-sided die” or “at least one pair of 1’s (snake-eyes) in 24 rolls of a pair of six-sided dice?” Or are they equally likely?

(a) **Pr(at least one 1 in 4 rolls of a 6-sided die)**

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Pr(at least one 1 in 4 rolls of a 6-sided die)} &= 1 - \text{Pr(no 1's in 4 rolls)} \\ &= 1 - \text{Pr(1st is not 1)} \times \text{Pr(2nd is not 1)} \times \text{Pr(3rd is not 1)} \times \text{Pr(4th is not 1)} \\ &= 1 - (5/6) \times (5/6) \times (5/6) \times (5/6) \\ &= 1 - (5/6)^4 \approx 52\%.\end{aligned}$$

(b) **Pr(at least one pair of 1’s in 24 rolls of a pair of 6-sided dice)**

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Pr(at least one pair of 1's in 24 rolls of a pair of 6-sided dice)} &= 1 - \text{Pr(no pairs of 1's in 24 rolls of a pair of dice)} \\ &= 1 - \{ \text{Pr(1st roll is not a pair of 1's)} \}^{24} \\ &= 1 - (35/36)^{24} \approx 49\%.\end{aligned}$$